



TOP 10 FIRMS IN TERMS OF PROFIT AFTER TAX

Most of the Top 10 companies, ex-BFSI, have seen their PAT improve in FY23

Rank	Company	Net profit* (FY23)
1	Reliance Industries	73,670 (11.31%)
2	Tata Consultancy Services	42,303 (10.02%)
3	Oil & Natural Gas Corporation	32,778 (-33.51%)
4	Coal India	28,125 (61.84%)
5	Infosys	24,108 (8.86%)
6	ITC	19,477 (25.63%)
7	NTPC	17,121 (0.95%)
8	Power Grid Corporation of India	15,417 (-8.36%)
9	HCL Technologies	14,845 (9.78%)
10	Vedanta	14,506 (-38.82%)

TOP 10 COMPANIES IN TERMS OF DEBT

Most firms, ex-BFSI, have seen a rise in their overall debt levels in FY23, compared to FY22

Rank	Company	Overall debt* (FY23)
1	Reliance Industries	3,13,966 (17.90%)
2	NTPC	2,20,022 (4.90%)
3	Vodafone Idea	2,01,586 (5.59%)
4	Bharti Airtel	1,65,545 (24.55%)
5	Indian Oil Corporation	1,40,115 (13.41%)
6	Oil & Natural Gas Corporation	1,29,186 (19.87%)
7	Power Grid Corporation Of India	1,26,595 (-5.99%)
8	Tata Motors	1,25,660 (-10.03%)
9	Larsen & Toubro	1,18,513 (-4.01%)
10	Grasim Industries	1,01,348 (38.48%)

*IN ₹ CRORE; FIGURES IN BRACKETS INDICATE YoY CHANGE **SOURCE** ACE EQUITY

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longer comment before changing to a more dovish stance... India-specific economic factors that are worrisome are not many, but worries about the BJP failing to get a clear majority on its own in next year's general elections [exist]," he adds.

That also explains the vagaries seen in the country's market capitalisation to GDP over the years, and more importantly, in the recent past. A recent report by Motilal Oswal Financial Services highlights this trend and states that this ratio fell to 95 per cent in FY23 from 113 per cent in FY22 and 103 per cent in FY21. In the current financial year, the ratio is pegged at 107 per cent—much above its long-term average of around 80 per cent—per the domestic broking major's analysis.

PROFIT AND BORROWINGS

Besides valuations, the BT500 study also has interesting insights with

respect to the overall health of the biggest companies of the country. For instance, this year's BT500 list includes 47 companies that saw their profit after tax (PAT) more than double in FY23 when compared to the previous financial year. This was, however, lower than last year's study that had 77 such instances.

Some of the prominent names that saw their PAT more than double in FY23 include Adani Enterprises, Bata India, Ceat, Sun Pharmaceutical, Just Dial, VIP Industries, Adani Power, Maruti Suzuki India and Raymond. On the other hand, companies like SAIL, BPCL, Tata Steel, JSW Steel, Glenmark Pharmaceuticals, Jindal Steel & Power, GAIL (India), Indian Oil Corporation, ACC, NMDC, and Vedanta saw a significant fall in their PAT in FY23 when compared to FY22.

"FY23 had been a strong earnings year for auto, capital goods, NBFCs,

insurance firms, and banks, as well as other sectors like tyres, real estate, etc., with a very strong growth in mid-caps and small-caps. On the other hand, cement, pharma, diagnostics saw a rout... Further deceleration should be expected as monetary tightening globally throughout 2022 and 2023 takes its toll on the growth of Indian companies' earnings," explains Venkataraman.

On a different note, the cumulative debt of the BT500 firms (ex-BFSI) in FY23 was pegged at ₹33.34 lakh crore, against cash and bank balance of nearly ₹8 lakh crore. Some of the companies that saw the maximum jump in their absolute debt levels include Sun Pharma, TV18 Broadcast, Hindustan Zinc, Biocon, JSW Energy, Network 18 Media & Investments, GAIL (India) and Aurobindo Pharma, among others. Meanwhile, entities like DLF, Mangalore Refinery & Petrochemicals, Indus Towers, Adani Power,